I could

Written by

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Trigger Warning: This script contains depictions of verbal threats, emotional abuse, alcohol intoxication, and relationship conflict, including the threat of physical violence. Reader discretion is advised.

INT. SMALL APARTMENT - NIGHT

A couple sits on a couch cuddling watching a TV. BEN (Mid 20s) is clearly drunk, glassy eyes, lazy grin, holding sipping on a beer. LUCY (early 20s) leans into his shoulder.

BEN
(slurring, with a crooked smile)
You know what, Loo? I could, like, I could beat you up.

The words hang in the air.

Lucy's face drains in shock. She pulls away to look at him.

LUCY
(quiet)
What did you just say?

Ben waves it off.

BEN
I said... I could TECHNICALLY beat the fuck out of you whenever I want.

Lucy's face pales as her face grows a smile. She the smile faces as fear overtakes.

BEN (cont'd)
(grinning)
Relax. I'm just messing around. Don't look at me like that.

LUCY
(voice shaking)
My boyfriend would never say that.

Ben blinks slowly.

BEN
(confused)
It's a joke, Lucy. God, can't you take a joke?

LUCY
No. That's not a joke. That's something you can't take back.
(voice rising)

Lucy eyes dart at the door then her keys on the counter.

LUCY (cont'd)
Not ever.

Ben leans closer and grabs her shoulder, smirk fading into frustration. Lucy attempts to weakly shrug it off as she recoils.

BEN
C'mon, don't be dramatic. You know I'd never hurt you.

Ben rubs her shoulder.

BEN (cont'd)
(slowly nodding his head)
Right?

LUCY
You just told me you could!

Lucy slaps the hand off her shoulder.

LUCY (cont'd)
Even drunk, you said it. And if you can say it once, you can mean it next time.

Ben exhales, rubbing his face with that hand, muttering.

BEN
You're twisting this. Please! I didn't mean it like that.

LUCY
How did you mean that?

Lucy talks with her arms.

LUCY (cont'd)
(mocking, bitter)
"Hey, my love, by the by, I could make you a fucking cartoon hole-in-the-wall if I wanted to!"

Ben's face brightens up.

BEN
Exactly! It was a joke!

Lucy stares at him. She pushes herself off the couch, her voice shaking with fury.

LUCY
What? No! I am so done!
(backing up toward the kitchen)
Fuck this! Fuck you!

She grabs her bag and keys from the counter.

Ben freezes, panic spreading across his face.

BEN
Lucy! Wait! I didn't—

Lucy walks toward the door but stops to answer him.

LUCY
(interrupting)
Didn't what? Say it? Because news-flash! You. Said. It.

Lucy starts for the door again.

Ben runs his fingers through his hard.

BEN
I'm not a monster!

Lucy looks over her shoulder.

LUCY
That's who you are tonight! Right now!

Lucy grabs the door handle.

Ben springs to him feet.

BEN
I would never ACTUALLY hurt you!

Ben walks toward her.

Lucy looks at the door handle. Her back towards him.

LUCY
Do you think I'm staying to test that theory? Not tonight. Not ever!

Ben stops in his tracks. Realization settling in.

Lucy looks back on last time.

LUCY (cont'd)
The person I loved wouldn't say something like that.

She slams the door behind her.

Ben returns to and sits on the couch, stunned. The silence is deafening. The TV flickers in the background.